

EMMANUEL BAHINDI

SOFTWARE ENGINEER • AI PRACTITIONER • SPEAKER ON AI & TECHNOLOGY IN AFRICA

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“I build software with AI every single day, and I teach a continent to do the same.”

Software engineer at the intersection of AI, media, and African innovation: I ship production web platforms with AI in the loop daily, designed the AI curriculum now training East Africa's journalism educators, and speak publicly on artificial intelligence, its future, and what it means for Africa.

SUMMARY

Software Engineer with 5 years designing, building, and deploying web applications end to end: requirements, architecture, development, deployment, documentation, and user training. Currently Multimedia Web Developer at Media Challenge Initiative and Project Technical Lead of its AI Media Lab, where I architect AI-powered learning platforms and lead AI capacity-building across Uganda and Kenya. 30+ delivered projects for NGOs and businesses. Daily practitioner of AI-assisted engineering: LLM-integrated products, prompt engineering, and AI-accelerated development, documentation, and content pipelines.

CORE COMPETENCIES

AI-Native Engineering: daily production use of LLMs • prompt engineering • LLM API integration • AI-assisted code, testing & documentation • AI ethics & verification frameworks (co-developed the Ubuntu AI Ethics Code training programme)

Full-Stack Development: JavaScript, PHP, HTML5, CSS3 • React, Next.js 14, Laravel, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap • MongoDB, MySQL, Sanity, Strapi • Git/GitHub, Jest, React Testing Library, Docker, Postman • system integration & database architecture • LAN/WAN administration

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Multimedia Web Developer & Technical Lead, AI Media Lab • Media Challenge Initiative

Aug 2023 – Present

4th Floor, Tirupati Mazima Mall, Kabalagala, Kampala, Uganda • +256 773 165 989

- Lead development and deployment of MCI's enterprise web estate with Next.js and React, owning the full lifecycle: the [MCI website](#), [Media Challenge Awards](#), [Fellowship](#), [Love Facts Stickers](#), and [Solutions Now Africa](#).
- Technical Lead on “Integrating AI Competences for Fighting Disinformation into Journalism Education in Eastern Africa” (with CAMECO, and BMZ): architected and shipped the programme's phone-first, low-data AI e-learning platform (launched Aug 2026).
- Co-designed and lead-facilitated a 5-day AI Training of Trainers for **22 university journalism educators from Uganda and Kenya**, who now deliver the curriculum to **400 students** across both countries.
- Authored the 4-course, video “AI for Journalists” curriculum (AI foundations, prompting, ethics, AI content creation), and serve as its on-camera instructor for the National Newsroom Contest 2026.

Founder & CEO • COTE TECH (U) LTD, Kampala

2024 – Present

- Founded and lead a digital solutions company delivering web platforms and AI-enabled products for organizations in Uganda and abroad, with AI-assisted engineering as standard practice across delivery.
- Serve as Chief Technology Officer to [INSPIRE AFRICA](#) (UK-registered labour-mobility organization): delivered its public website end to end, from design to deployment and handover.
- Architected INSPIRE AFRICA's Central Database platform: role-based access for 29 staff job titles, two-factor authentication, audit logging, and separate candidate (Readiness) and employer (Roster) portals built around data-protection-by-design.
- Authored the platform's official user guide and staff training programme, turning a complex system into documentation any staff member can follow.

IT Officer (Intern) • Baylor Foundation Uganda, Kampala

Sep 2022 – Mar 2023

- Developed and maintained business-process automation solutions that improved operational efficiency by **30%**.
- Designed and implemented web interfaces for internal systems using React and Tailwind CSS.
- Conducted system analysis and provided recommendations for process improvements adopted across departments.

- Provided organization-wide IT support and user training, managed LAN/WAN networks and hardware, and created technical documentation and user guides for all implemented systems.

Full-Stack Software Developer (Freelance) • Kampala

2020 – 2022

- Delivered **30+ projects** for NGOs and businesses, handling the full engagement solo: requirements, design, build, deployment, hosting and client training.
- Built client platforms across agriculture, health, education and logistics, including [TAPA](#), [Passionate Hearts Ministries](#), [Musawo Betty Care & Research Center](#), and [Maritime Shipping Company Ltd.](#)
- Specialized in affordable, low-maintenance stacks (React, PHP/Laravel, WordPress-free custom builds) suited to small-organization budgets and Ugandan hosting realities.
- Maintained long-term support relationships with clients, several of which remain live and under my care today.

PUBLIC SPEAKING & MEDIA (SELECTED)

- [“Starlink Is a Meaningful Disruptor”: Satellite Internet vs Africa's Telecom Giants](#) — Switch Africa (TikTok): technology analysis on connectivity and competition in East Africa.
- [Highlight Video for the AI Journalism | AI Media Lab ToT](#) — YouTube, Media Challenge Initiative: lead facilitator of the 5-day AI Training of Trainers, Kampala, Jul 2026.
- [AI vs Human Intelligence](#) — The Rest of Us podcast (TikTok): guest speaker on artificial intelligence and the future of human work.
- “The Wise Man and the Clever Machine: Who Serves Whom?” — Guest Speaker on AI, Rotary Club of Makindye, Kampala, Aug 2026.

Available for keynotes, panels, and trainings on: AI and the future of work in Africa • AI-driven disinformation and how societies fight it • practical AI adoption for organizations • building AI-era digital products for low-bandwidth markets.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BSc. Software Engineering • Makerere University, Kampala

2019 – 2024

- Final-year project: Fuel Demand Forecasting System (using AI). Coursework: SDLC, database management, system integration, software testing.

Responsive Web Design • freeCodeCamp

2023